

FILM DOSSIER: FANTASTIC FOUR

Phase 2 · Film #3 (Saga Film #11)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE.  Waiting on the showrunner's real-actor casting picks (see Section 2).

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	11 of 29 (Phase 2, Film #3)
Phase	Phase 2
Real title	<i>FANTASTIC FOUR</i>
Decoy / codename title	<i>"FOUR CORNERS"</i>
Release date	Friday, November 8, 2013 (52 years almost to the month after Fantastic Four #1, November 1961)
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Brad Bird
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 150 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + retro-futurist sci-fi family adventure

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	The Fantastic Four ensemble (real actors, the showrunner's picks). Marvel's first family has its own franchise.

Real-actor cast: 🕒 SHOWRUNNER'S PICKS

*Ages are at release. Bold = recommended. On 616 in 1961, Reed is the oldest, Sue is in her twenties, and Johnny is a teenager.***

Character	Options (age at release)	Notes
Reed Richards / Mr. Fantastic	Pedro Pascal (38) · Ioan Gruffudd (40) · Miles Teller (26)	Pascal fits Reed as the older, graying genius
Sue Storm / the Invisible Woman	Vanessa Kirby (25) · Jessica Alba (32) · Kate Mara (30)	Kirby matches Sue's 616 age
Johnny Storm / the Human Torch	Joseph Quinn (20) · Chris Evans (32) · Michael B. Jordan (26)	Quinn is closest to 616's teenage Johnny
Ben Grimm / the Thing (<i>on-set performance capture and practical prosthetic suit</i>)	Ebon Moss-Bachrach (36) · Michael Chiklis (50) · Jamie Bell (27)	Moss-Bachrach fits Ben as Reed's college roommate and a test pilot
Victor von Doom / Doctor Doom	Robert Downey Jr. (48) · Julian McMahon (45) · Toby Kebbell (31)	In our reality, Downey never played Tony Stark , so he's free to be Doom. He has the gravitas of a monarch and a genius.
Alicia Masters	Kerry Washington (36)	The only real actor to have played her
Harvey Elder / the Mole Man	Paul Walter Hauser (27)	The only real actor to have played him
Uatu the Watcher	Jeffrey Wright (47)	The only real actor to have played him

Character	Actor	Age at release
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: Willie Lumpkin, the FF's mailman, as on 616</i>)	Stan Lee	90

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>Fantastic Four</i> #1 (November 1961), Stan Lee & Jack Kirby: the rocket flight, the cosmic rays , the four powers, the Mole Man . <i>Fantastic Four</i> #5 (July 1962): Doctor Doom .
Supporting comics	<i>FF</i> #8 (1962, Alicia Masters) · <i>FF</i> #13 (1963, Uatu the Watcher , the Blue Area of the Moon) · <i>FF Annual</i> #2 (1964, "The Fantastic Origin of Doctor Doom": the college accident, Latveria, the mask) · <i>FF</i> #22 (1963, Sue's force fields) · <i>FF</i> #48 (1966, the Watcher sees the Silver Surfer coming) · Jonathan Hickman's <i>FF</i> (2009–12, Doom as a master sorcerer and scientist)
Nerf check	☒ Doom beats all four of them in their first fight. They win in the end only because Reed out-thinks him and Sue holds him with a force field that no one else could produce. Doom is a scientist, a sorcerer and a monarch at full strength.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	96% . <i>FF</i> #1 and Doom's origin are both taken from the page.

Straight from the page:

- **Reed Richards** takes his fiancée **Sue**, her teenage brother **Johnny**, and his best friend, pilot **Ben Grimm**, on an **unauthorized spaceflight**. The ship **isn't shielded against cosmic rays** (Ben warned him), and they crash back to Earth changed (*FF* #1).
- **The powers**: Reed stretches, Sue turns invisible, Johnny **bursts into flame and flies** ("**Flame on!**"), and **Ben turns into the rock-skinned Thing** permanently, and it's a tragedy for him (*FF* #1).
- **Reed names them "the Fantastic Four"**, and they go public. They're **celebrities**, the opposite of the X-Men (*FF* #1–3).
- **The Mole Man** attacks from **Subterranea** with giant monsters (*FF* #1).
- **Victor von Doom**: Reed's **rival at Empire State University**. His forbidden experiment to reach his mother's soul in the underworld **explodes**, and Reed had warned him. He **blames Reed**, goes to Tibet, puts on **the mask while it's still red-hot**, and **rules Latveria** (*FF Annual* #2).
- **Alicia Masters**, a blind sculptor, loves Ben for who he is (*FF* #8).
- **The Baxter Building**, 42nd Street and Madison Avenue, and **Yancy Street**.
- **Uatu the Watcher** on the Moon's **Blue Area**, watching and never interfering (*FF* #13).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The flight is to **study cosmic-ray storms**, not to **beat the Communists to space** | Sliding timescale |

| Doom's first appearance (#5, 1962) is in the origin film | Runtime. He's the FF's greatest enemy. |
 | Sue's force fields (1963) from the start | The **latest 616 version**: she's the team's most powerful member |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Mr. Fantastic	Stretches to extreme lengths ; shape-shifts his body; absorbs impacts; one of the smartest people on Earth (<i>FF</i> #1)	Stretches across a city block, catches a falling Johnny, turns into a parachute, beats Doom by out-thinking him	–	✓ 100%
The Invisible Woman	Invisibility ; turns other things invisible; force fields strong enough to hold back tidal waves and planetary-scale forces (<i>FF</i> #1, #22)	Invisibility; a force field that stops a Mole Man monster; holding Doom in a force bubble at the climax	Her planet-scale shields (with future threats)	✓ 100%
The Human Torch	Flame on : full-body plasma flame, flight , fireballs, heat absorption; the nova flame (<i>FF</i> #1)	Flight at Mach speeds, fireballs, melting a monster's hide	The nova flame (it comes with a bigger threat)	✓ 100%
The Thing	Rock-hide body : class 85–100 strength, near-invulnerable; a brawler; ex-Marine test pilot (<i>FF</i> #1)	Throws a subway car, wrestles the Mole Man's giant monster, takes a Doom energy blast and keeps coming. "It's clobberin' time!"	–	✓ 100%
Doctor Doom	One of the smartest people on Earth (Reed's equal); master sorcerer ; the Doom armor (force fields, energy blasts, flight, life support); Doombots ; the time platform ; absolute ruler of Latveria (<i>FF</i> #5, Hickman)	Doombots, the armor's full arsenal, sorcery (he casts a spell that makes Reed's body go rigid), a glimpse of the time platform	Using the time platform (a later film)	✓ 100%
The Mole Man	Master of Subterranea: giant monsters , Moloids , a "sixth sense" in the dark (<i>FF</i> #1)	Monsters coming up through Manhattan	–	✓ 100%
The Watcher	A cosmic being of enormous power, sworn never to interfere	The post-credit scene	–	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	Four people take a rocket past the edge of the sky and come back as a family of freaks and heroes. The man who blames the smartest of them for his ruined face is coming to take everything.
Theme	Family. Powers aren't what make them fantastic. Coming back to each other is.
Villain / antagonist	Doctor Doom (main); the Mole Man (Act One)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE COSMIC STORM

- **Monday, August 12, 2013. Dr. Reed Richards** has built a spacecraft to study the **cosmic-ray storm** forecast to pass Earth. NASA won't clear it.
- Reed goes anyway, with **Sue**, her 17-year-old brother **Johnny**, and his best friend, test pilot **Ben Grimm**, who warns him the shielding isn't good enough.
- The storm hits and they crash in a field in upstate New York.
- One by one, they change: stretching, vanishing, bursting into flame, and **Ben's skin turning to orange rock**. Ben stays that way.
- **The Mole Man** attacks New York from beneath the streets. The four fight side by side for the first time. Reed calls them **the Fantastic Four** on live TV.

ACT TWO: FIRST FAMILY

- They move into the **Baxter Building**. Unlike the X-Men, they're adored: talk shows, toy deals, and mail delivered by **Willie Lumpkin**.
- Ben meets **Alicia Masters**, a blind sculptor who sees him the way nobody else does.
- **Victor von Doom, the monarch of Latveria**, invites Reed to Doomstadt as an "old friend" from **Empire State University**. Reed tells Sue about the accident years ago: Victor's forbidden experiment, and the warning Victor ignored.
- In Latveria, Doom **reveals what he wants: to take the cosmic energy in the Four's bodies** for himself.
- **Round one: Doom beats all four of them.**

ACT THREE: CLOBBERIN' TIME

- The Four break out of the Doombots' cells, with Johnny burning through the walls and Ben tearing out the door.
- Doom starts the power transfer. **Sue holds him in a force field** while **Reed out-thinks the machine** and reverses it, and the backlash throws Doom across his own throne room.
- **The Thing** stands over him: **"It's clobberin' time."**
- Doom escapes by **teleporting away through sorcery**. It's the first time Reed has seen magic, and it shakes him.

- Home at the Baxter Building. Reed proposes to Sue for the second time, **properly this time**. Ben laughs. Johnny flames on and writes a giant "4" in the sky over Manhattan.

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, August 12, 2013 → Saturday, October 19, 2013. The post-credit scene takes place the same night .
Where it's set	The Baxter Building, 42nd & Madison, NYC · Yancy Street · Monster Isle / Subterranea · Latveria (Doomstadt, Castle Doom) (filmed in the Czech Republic and Slovenia) · the Blue Area of the Moon
Relative to other films	Six weeks after <i>Thor: Stormbreaker</i>. The thaw in Manhattan is on the news the morning they launch.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **The cosmic rays**, the Baxter Building, Yancy Street, Alicia, Willie Lumpkin.
- **Latveria** and **Doom**, the greatest villain in the Marvel Universe.
- **The FF as celebrities**, the opposite of the feared X-Men.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
The Avengers	Johnny mocks the Avengers at a press junket. Cap calls to congratulate them, and Johnny panics.	<i>Avengers 2</i>
Namor	Namor, watching from the harbor, notices Sue (616)	A future Namor/FF story
Magic is science's rival	Doom is both a scientist and a sorcerer	Doctor Strange (Phase 2/3)
Doom	He escapes by sorcery	Doom returns (in 616 he's always the big one)

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
The Watcher	The post-credit scene	Two cosmic storms are coming: Galactus and Thanos
The Silver Surfer	The post-credit scene	The herald of Galactus (616: <i>FF</i> #48), and on 616 a key player in <i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i>

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "THE MASK." Castle Doom, at night. Doom sits alone and lifts his mask . We see only Doom's reaction in a mirror, not his face. He puts the mask back on and turns to a Doombot : <i>"Richards thinks he has won. Prepare the time platform."</i>
Post-credit scene	✓ "THE WATCHER." The Blue Area of the Moon . Uatu the Watcher , enormous and silent, looks down at Earth. Then he looks out into space, and his face, which has never shown fear, shows fear . UATU (to no one): <i>"The Titan gathers his jewels. The Devourer grows hungry. And his herald is already on the way."</i> Far out past Saturn, a silver streak cuts through the stars toward Earth. CUT TO BLACK. "THE FANTASTIC FOUR WILL RETURN."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "MIRROR MIRROR." Post-credit: "MOON LANDING."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline · ⌚ Real-actor casting picks